

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form US-CORE-A

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam completed during the New Deal era. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) How did New Deal programs like the TVA, shown in this photograph, represent a change in the role of the federal government?

- A. The government reduced its involvement in the economy and allowed private industry to manage recovery
- B. The TVA was a private utility corporation that operated without any federal funding or oversight
- C. The federal government took direct responsibility for economic development and public welfare
- D. The federal government's role remained unchanged from the policies of the 1920s

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: The TVA represented a dramatic expansion of federal power. For the first time, the government directly owned and operated an electric utility, planned regional economic development, and employed thousands of workers. This reflected FDR's philosophy that the government had a responsibility to ensure economic security and development.

A — The TVA is the clearest case of the opposite: the federal government built and ran dams and sold the power itself.

B — The TVA was created by Congress in 1933 as a federally owned corporation. Reading it as private misses why critics called it socialism.

D — Federal public works on this scale had no 1920s precedent; that discontinuity is the point of the image.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must read an image of infrastructure and infer what it shows about the federal government's role — a relationship between evidence and a claim, which is DOK-2. Naming the agency in the photograph would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — reverses the direction of federal involvement under the New Deal; **B** — mistakes a federally owned corporation for a private company; **D** — treats the New Deal as continuous with 1920s policy

2. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam, c. 1936. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) Evaluate the extent to which the TVA and similar New Deal programs achieved their goals of economic recovery and reform.

- A. New Deal programs completely ended the Great Depression and eliminated poverty in the United States
- B. New Deal programs had no positive effects and actually worsened economic conditions
- C. The TVA only benefited wealthy landowners and provided no assistance to ordinary citizens
- D. The TVA brought electricity, jobs, and flood control to a poor region, but full economic recovery required the industrial mobilization of World War II

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: The TVA successfully electrified the Tennessee Valley, controlled flooding, created thousands of jobs, and improved agricultural practices. However, it also displaced communities and the broader New Deal reduced unemployment from 25% to about 14% — significant relief but not full recovery. The complete end of the Depression came with WWII industrial mobilization.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s “court packing” attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 0.9 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) How did the Berlin Airlift shown in this photograph reflect the U.S. policy of containment during the early Cold War?

- A. The U.S. showed resolve against Soviet expansion without direct force
- B. The U.S. used military force to drive Soviet troops out of the eastern sector of Berlin
- C. The U.S. imposed economic sanctions that forced the Soviet Union to end communism
- D. The U.S. negotiated a peace treaty that divided Germany into permanent zones

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Berlin Airlift exemplified containment by resisting Soviet pressure over West Berlin through non-military means, demonstrating American commitment to opposing communist expansion without triggering direct armed conflict.

B — No Soviet troops were driven out. The airlift deliberately avoided force by flying over the blockade instead of breaking it.

C — Sanctions were not the instrument, and Soviet communism continued for four more decades.

D — Germany's division was not settled by a treaty during the airlift; the blockade ended in 1949 without one.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must interpret an image of a supply flight and infer the strategic message it sent — evidence to inference, which is DOK-2. Identifying the aircraft or the city would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

B — reads a non-military response as a military one; **C** — attributes the end of Soviet communism to a 1948 operation; **D** — invents a negotiated settlement for the blockade

4. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows American soldiers during the Korean War, c. 1950. (U.S. Army photograph, c. 1950. Public Domain.) Which statement best analyzes the long-term consequences of the Korean War for U.S. foreign policy and military strategy?

- A. The war had no lasting consequences because it ended in a stalemate
- B. The war established a precedent for limited wars to contain communism, expanded the permanent military establishment, and deepened Cold War alliances in Asia
- C. The war resulted in the reunification of Korea and permanent peace in the region
- D. The Korean War convinced the United States to abandon the containment policy in favor of isolationism

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Korean War had profound long-term consequences: it established the model of 'limited war' (fighting to contain rather than defeat communism); led to a permanent U.S. military presence in South Korea; tripled the U.S. defense budget; expanded NATO; created bilateral defense treaties across Asia (SEATO, bilateral pacts with Japan, South Korea, Philippines); and set precedents later applied in Vietnam.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 1.0 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

5. Which earlier Supreme Court doctrine did Brown v. Board of Education overturn in public education?

- A. The exclusionary rule established in Mapp v. Ohio
- B. Judicial review established in Marbury v. Madison
- C. The 'separate but equal' doctrine established in Plessy v. Ferguson
- D. The 'clear and present danger' test established in Schenck v. United States

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.74

Why the key is right: Brown v. Board of Education (347 U.S. 483, 1954) unanimously overturned the 'separate but equal' doctrine that the Court had established in Plessy v. Ferguson (163 U.S. 537, 1896). The Brown Court held that 'separate educational facilities are inherently unequal,' violating the Fourteenth Amendment's Equal Protection Clause. Marbury (judicial review), Mapp (exclusionary rule), and Schenck (clear and present danger) involve unrelated constitutional doctrines.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of Brown v. Board of Education on the desegregation of schools, such as Scarboro 85, Clinton 12 and Little Rock 9. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.8 · b -1.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

6. How did the Supreme Court's ruling in Brown v. Board of Education (1954) differ from its earlier ruling in Plessy v. Ferguson (1896)?

- A. Brown required the immediate integration of all public facilities, while Plessy had only applied to railroad cars
- B. Brown extended voting rights to African Americans, while Plessy had restricted their access to public accommodations
- C. Brown applied only to Southern states, while Plessy had established a national standard for racial equality
- D. Brown rejected the 'separate but equal' doctrine by ruling that racially segregated schools were inherently unequal, while Plessy had upheld racial separation as constitutional

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.74

Why the key is right: Brown v. Board directly overturned the 'separate but equal' precedent established by Plessy v. Ferguson by finding that segregated schools caused inherent psychological and educational harm to Black children, making them constitutionally unequal regardless of physical facilities.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of Brown v. Board of Education on the desegregation of schools, such as Scarboro 85, Clinton 12 and Little Rock 9. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b -0.3 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

7. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows soldiers of the U.S. Army's 101st Airborne Division escorting African American students into Little Rock Central High School in Arkansas in September 1957. President Eisenhower deployed federal troops after Arkansas Governor Orval Faubus used the state National Guard to block the students' entry. (Photograph, September 1957. U.S. Army.) Why did President Eisenhower send federal troops to Little Rock, Arkansas, as shown in this photograph?

- A. To enforce the Brown v. Board ruling and ensure the desegregation of Central High School
- B. To suppress a labor strike that had shut down the city's schools
- C. To implement the Civil Rights Act of 1957, which required integrated schools
- D. To protect the school from a foreign military threat during the Cold War

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.76

Why the key is right: President Eisenhower sent the 101st Airborne to Little Rock to enforce the federal court order to desegregate Central High School, upholding the Supreme Court's 1954 Brown v. Board of Education decision after Governor Faubus defied it.

Item analysis

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.0 · b -1.1 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

8. How did Thurgood Marshall and Malcolm X differ in their approaches to achieving racial equality in the United States?

- A. Marshall focused on economic empowerment for African Americans, while Malcolm X concentrated on legal strategies to dismantle segregation
- B. Marshall pursued racial equality through legal challenges within the existing system, while Malcolm X initially advocated for Black self-determination and separation from white-dominated institutions
- C. Marshall supported armed resistance against racial injustice, while Malcolm X argued exclusively for legal challenges through the court system
- D. Marshall worked to integrate African Americans into mainstream American society, while Malcolm X rejected any form of civic participation

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.76

Why the key is right: Thurgood Marshall operated through the NAACP and federal courts to dismantle legal segregation. Malcolm X, shaped by the Nation of Islam, rejected integration and called for Black self-sufficiency and separation from white institutions.

Item analysis

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

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Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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9. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the Selma to Montgomery marches in Alabama, March 1965. (Photograph, March 1965.) Why were the Selma marches necessary despite the passage of the Civil Rights Act of 1964?

- A. The Civil Rights Act of 1964 was declared unconstitutional by the Supreme Court
- B. The Selma marches were unrelated to voting and focused only on desegregating schools
- C. The 1964 Act addressed public accommodations and employment but did not effectively address voter suppression
- D. African Americans in the South were not aware that they had the right to vote

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.78

Why the key is right: While the Civil Rights Act of 1964 banned discrimination in public accommodations and employment, it did not adequately address voting rights. Southern states continued using literacy tests, poll taxes, and intimidation to prevent Black voter registration, making additional legislation necessary.

Item analysis

Standard

US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

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Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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10. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the Selma to Montgomery marches, Alabama, March 1965. (Photograph, March 1965.) How did the Voting Rights Act of 1965, prompted by the events shown in this photograph, transform political participation in the American South?

- A.** It granted voting rights only to African Americans who owned property in southern states
- B.** It had little effect because southern states found legal ways to continue preventing African Americans from voting
- C.** It was enforced only in Alabama and did not extend to voter registration in other Southern states
- D.** It eliminated literacy tests and authorized federal oversight of voter registration, leading to large increases in Black voter registration

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.78

Why the key is right: The Voting Rights Act of 1965 was transformative: it banned literacy tests nationwide, authorized federal registrars and observers in areas with histories of discrimination, and required jurisdictions with discriminatory histories to obtain federal approval before changing voting laws. Black voter registration in Mississippi rose from 6.7% to 59.8% within two years.

Item analysis

Standard

US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

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Bias / sensitivity

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Citation

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Historian review

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Distractor diagnosis

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